

Understanding Your Child's Assessment & Eligibility

California School Psychologist Hub · Parallel Learning · Family information sheet

OPTIONAL CASE INFORMATION

Student

Meeting Date (MM/DD/YYYY)

Case Manager

School Contact

Phone

Email

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT?

Referral -> Assessment Plan -> Testing -> Report -> IEP Meeting -> Eligibility Decision -> Services Begin

WHAT THE ASSESSMENT IS

The school psychologist looks at how your child learns across areas like thinking, academics, communication, behavior, and social-emotional skills. Nothing changes about your child's program unless the team meets and you agree.

YOUR RIGHTS & TIMELINE

You have at least 15 days to review and sign the assessment plan. After you sign, the team completes the assessment and holds the IEP meeting within 60 days (school breaks may pause this). You are a full member of the IEP team.

WHAT ELIGIBILITY MEANS

Qualifying for special education means your child is entitled to support designed for their needs, reviewed at least once a year. It is a plan, not a limiting label.

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Does testing automatically mean my child qualifies? No. The team reviews the results together and decides whether your child meets the criteria and needs special education support.

Can I refuse testing? Yes. Testing requires your written consent. If you don't consent, the assessment won't move forward, though the school may still talk with you about next steps.

Can I bring someone to the meeting? Yes. You're welcome to bring a family member, friend, or advocate who knows your child.

Can I request an Independent Educational Evaluation? Yes. If you disagree with the school's evaluation, you can request an Independent Educational Evaluation at public expense.